

Hello Everyone, this is group 9 and today we will be performing a discussion for our group assignment for the course Philosophy 2150. For our group assignment we created a deep fake and we are going to have a debate on whether it is real or not, I am Garret and I will be your moderator.

Title: Deepfake Debate: Is It Real or Fake?

Cast:

- **Student 1** – Believes the video is real
- **Student 2** – Skeptical but unsure
- **Student 3** – Argues it's a deepfake
- **Student 4** – Moderator, guiding the discussion

Scene: Four students sitting at a table, watching the deepfake video of a celebrity announcing their visit to MUN and urging viewers to buy tickets. The debate unfolds.

Student 4 (Moderator): Welcome, everyone. Today, we're discussing whether this viral video of [Celebrity] coming to MUN is real or a deepfake. Let's start with _____. What do you think?

Student 1: Look, the video looks totally real. The voice, the expressions, the movement—it all checks out. If this were fake, wouldn't there be obvious glitches or distortions? Plus, why would someone go through the effort of making something like this if it weren't true?

Student 2: I mean, I want to believe it's real. But with all the deepfake technology we've been learning about, I'm not so sure. Didn't we talk about how AI can mimic human speech and facial expressions with crazy accuracy?

Student 3: Exactly, [Kyle](#)! This is classic deepfake deception. Remember what Regina Rini (2020) said about the **epistemic backstop**? Videos used to be undeniable proof, but deepfakes undermine that. Just because it looks real doesn't mean it is. Algorithms can generate hyper-realistic speech and movement using **GANs**—Generative Adversarial Networks. This video could have been stitched together from different clips or even fully generated from scratch!

Student 1: But wouldn't there be forensic signs of manipulation? I heard there are AI tools that can detect deepfakes. Has anyone tested the video?

Student 3: That's the problem. Deepfake detection tools aren't perfect, and as detection improves, so does generation. It's an arms race. Plus, the **liar's dividend** makes this even worse—real videos can now be dismissed as fake, and fake ones accepted as real!

Student 2: So, if we can't trust video evidence anymore, what happens to things like journalism, legal evidence, or even history? Doesn't this create an **epistemic crisis**?

[Kyle](#)
Student 3: Exactly! And don't forget the ethical implications. Imagine this scam spreading and people actually buying fake tickets. That's **misinformation** on a massive scale. This could damage MUN's reputation, cost people money, and erode trust in real announcements.

Student 1: But deepfakes aren't always bad. Couldn't this technology be used for good? Think about digital resurrections in film or accessibility tools for people who've lost their voices.

Student 4 (Moderator): That's a fair point. But do the risks outweigh the benefits? Should there be stronger regulations?

Student 3: Absolutely. Laws need to catch up. Right now, deepfakes can be used for fraud, political disinformation, and even **privacy violations** like non-consensual deepfake pornography. We need stricter policies, better forensic tools, and digital literacy programs to teach people how to spot fakes.

Student 2: So, what do we do? How do we navigate a world where seeing is no longer believing? So, what do we do? You mentioned Rini earlier, doesn't she warn us of the distinctive psychological concerns about videos in particular compared to the psychological response to photos? How do we navigate a world where seeing is no longer believing?

Student 4 (Moderator): Great question! I think we've reached an important realization: deepfakes challenge our perception of truth, and while detection tools and regulations can help, education and critical thinking are key. Thanks, everyone, for this discussion!

(End Scene)